Samuel T Sawian

Senior Game Producer | Product Manager | Game Discovery & Evaluation

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SUMMARY

Senior Producer and Product Manager with 15+ years building and operating live, free-to-play games and digital products. Hands-on experience using market intelligence tools (Sensor Tower, App Annie) to evaluate game concepts, mechanics, and competitive positioning ahead of greenlighting — including the discovery process behind Kitty Journey (250K downloads in 3 months). Currently integrates AI tools into feature design and prototyping at Dentira, and has designed and built AI-assisted websites and Figma prototypes. Strong background in systems design, roadmap ownership, LiveOps execution, and post-launch optimization across games and SaaS platforms.

SKILLS

Market Intelligence & Evaluation (Sensor Tower, App Annie) • AI-Assisted Prototyping & Development • Figma • Product & Feature Ownership • LiveOps & Post-Launch Optimization • Roadmap Planning & Prioritization • Systems & Game Design Thinking • Cross-Functional Leadership • Delivery, Scope & Risk Management • Jira & Release/Version Management

EXPERIENCE

Product Manager — *Dentira* April 2025 – Present

- Own live product delivery for a workflow-driven SaaS platform
- Drive roadmap planning, sprint execution, and releases
- Lead feature development across approvals, integrations, and automation flows
- Use AI tools to design and prototype feature improvements and workflow changes, alongside Figma for interface design
- Balance scope, dependencies, and delivery velocity in production

Visiting Faculty — *National Institute of Design* 2024 – 2025

- Taught foundations of Game Mechanics and Level Design
- Mentored final-semester diploma projects on pitches, mechanics, systems, and narrative design
- Served as Jury Member for graduation projects

CEO & Co-Founder — *Barking Deer Entertainment* 2018 – 2025

- Founded and led a design-led studio delivering games, products, and cultural platforms
- Owned creative direction, production planning, and end-to-end delivery
- Applied game design, UX, and systems thinking across all engagements
- Designed and built a website (happyfeetshillong.com) using AI-assisted development tools

Selected work:

Meghalayan Age — Government of Meghalaya: led brand identity, visual design, and storytelling for a state-backed cultural platform; shaped narratives around indigenous food products and regional heritage; collaborated on digital + physical retail experiences (New Delhi store).

nULTA — Healthcare Platform (COVID Response): repositioned a fragmented doctor marketplace into a guided healthcare platform; shipped an AI-assisted triage flow with GP oversight; scaled onboarding to 1,000+ doctors.

Recycled Earth (UNICEF-recognized): co-owned product vision and delivery for a multi-stakeholder waste-management platform; applied gamified progress and contribution systems; scaled to 22,000+ families and 950 housing societies.

7 Sisters Kitchen: supported a cultural media platform combining a recipe repository and documentary content; content achieved tens of thousands of views on YouTube.

Game Producer — Kitty Journey — *V11 Studio Game* 2017 – 2019

- Led and managed a studio of ~12 artists, engineers, and designers, including hiring, while coordinating external development, QA, and sound teams

- Used Sensor Tower and App Annie to evaluate market opportunity, mechanics, and competitive positioning ahead of greenlighting the concept
- Launched in-house IP achieving 250K downloads in 3 months based on that evaluation process
- Coordinated external QA, sound, and localization teams; evangelized Jira studio-wide to manage delivery overlaps between internal and external teams
- Owned feature delivery, milestone planning, and release execution

Game Producer — Teen Patti Gold — *Moonfrog Labs* 2017

- Managed producers, game/UX designers, and technical artists; held hiring responsibility for producer roles
- Supported development of VIP subscription features for a top-grossing mobile card game
- Collaborated on retention systems and player experience improvements
- Helped build and launch the web version with an external development team

Game Producer — *Zynga — FarmVille 2* 2015 – 2016

- Boosted FarmVille 2 daily active users by 300K through content and optimization initiatives
- Core team member in transitioning the game from San Francisco to India
- Led the Content Team and defined a 5-year product vision; Platform: Facebook

Associate Game Producer — Bingo Bash — *Bash Gaming / GSN Games* 2013 – 2015

- Owned and shipped retention and LiveOps features, improving baseline revenue by ~$250K
- Supported LiveOps for a ~4M MAU, >$1M monthly revenue title
- Led content planning, live feature execution, and roadmap support
- Contributed to mechanics design and UI/UX standards
- Part of the growth phase leading to a $165M acquisition

Senior Game Designer: Serious Games — *Tata Interactive Systems* 2012 – 2013

- Designed and delivered RPGs, ARGs, and behaviour-change games for Fortune 500 clients
- Pitched proposals and demos to senior management and CXOs
- Led a design team through prototyping to gold release, ensuring quality and client satisfaction

Game Producer — *Gameloft Games* 2011 – 2012

- Directed 50+ onshore/offshore developers, designers, and QA teams to deliver top-tier mobile titles
- Coordinated with senior executives and partners to define requirements, provide updates, and drive value-added features

EDUCATION

Game Design Diploma (PGDP), Vancouver Film School, Canada — 2009–2010

PGDP New Media Design, National Institute of Design, Ahmedabad — 2006–2009

Bachelor of Computer Applications, Bangalore University — 2002–2005

AWARDS & HONORS

Kickstart Grant – Original IP in Production, PRIME Meghalaya (Jan 2025) • Action4Change Feature – Recycled Earth, BDE & UNICEF (Mar 2022) • Green Beret Award, Zynga (Feb 2016) • Samurai Award, Zynga (Dec 2015) • Winner, Game Design Challenge: Constructive Destruction, Gamasutra (Jul 2015) • Quarterly Performance Award, Bingo Bash (Jun 2014) • Excellence in Learning: Bronze, Tata Interactive Systems & Brandon Hall (Oct 2013) • Best Use of Games and Simulations for Learning: Bronze, Tata Interactive Systems & Brandon Hall (Sep 2013) • Best Elearning Game: Gold Medal in Design, Tata Interactive Systems & LearnX Asia Pacific (May 2013)

WORKSHOPS & TALKS

Short Stories in Gahndruk – A Creative Writing Adventure, Kuhiro Class (Jan 2026) • Pitch Deck 101, Rishi Valley School (Sep 2024) • The Art of Making Games, Rishi Valley School (Jan 2024) • Talking Entrepreneurship, Annual Sawkpoh Durbar (Jan 2023) • The World of Video Games, SOS Children's Villages (Dec 2020)

LANGUAGES

English (Native/Bilingual) • Khasi (Native/Bilingual) • Hindi (Professional Working)